

# James 'Rusty' Speidel

3603 Ducati Way, Saint George, UT 84790

(M) 770-490-6040

[RustySpy@gmail.com](mailto:RustySpy@gmail.com)

Saint George, Utah

**Introduction:** Uniquely qualified IT leader and software developer with over twenty years of experience delivering software solutions. Experienced developer, solution architect, ScrumMaster, project manager, and software development team manager, but still loves to writing code. Driven by the challenge of fostering high-performing teams and watching those teams deliver real digital transformations.

**Technologies:** SQL Server, T-SQL, C#, ASP, .NET, HTML, CSS, jQuery, Angular, React, MVC, MVVM, Bootstrap, XML, XSLT, RegEx, Redis, Azure DevOps, JIRA, Dapper, LINQ to Entities/SQL, GIT, Team Foundation Server (TFS), and others

**Objective:** Seeking to leverage my talents in a dynamic organization to deliver solutions that make a difference.

## Education



**Brigham Young University**  
Bachelor's Degree  
Management Information Systems  
Marriott School of Management



**Auburn University**  
Masters of Business Administration  
Information Technology Concentration  
Raymond J. Harbert College of Business

## Professional Certifications



[Project Management Professional](#)  
Project Management Institute



[Certified ScrumMaster \(CSM\)](#)  
ScrumAlliance



**Foundation V3**  
[ITIL Foundation V3](#)  
Axelos Global Best Practice



**MCSD**  
Microsoft

## Professional Experience

### Senior Full-stack Software Engineer

**Embark Insurance**, Sandy Springs, GA.

8/2020 – 3/2025

Embark MGA is auto insurance company that serves FL, MA, PA, CA, and AL markets. Their systems are built upon SQL Server, COSMOS, C#, .NET Web API's, Angular, and other technologies.

- Developed many new features and new insurance products into our systems; regular project work.
- Worked directly with clients outside of IT to develop requirements, write user stories, testing procedures/scenarios, and acceptance criteria.
- Upgraded Angular 5, 6, and 7 projects to Angular 18.
- Implemented PostMan in our organization enabling our team to share access to our API endpoints.
- Implemented PostMan API monitoring that executed daily and hourly to monitor all our vital endpoints and send notifications if anything failed or executed out of spec.
- Upgraded projects (.NET 3, 4.5, core) to .NET 6 and then .NET 8.
- Added [swagger](#) to all our Web API's.
- Integrated several external insurance raters to use our platform to submit quotes and receive rates. These raters included Bindable, GetJerry, Insurify, Ocho, PLRater, and QuinSreet.
- Performed numerous API performance optimizations using asynchronous processing and caching.
- Authored IIS URL Rewriting rules to route external rater requests to any test environment we choose. This allowed us to point any rater to any test environment without having to ask the rater to change the URL they were using.

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## Consulting

### inLogic, NetOne, Thrive Technologies

5/2020 – 8/2020

Worked several small gigs for past acquaintances within the IT community

- inLogic - Converted an ASP.NET web application using forms authentication and custom permissions to Azure AD single-sign on (SSO) for authentication while maintaining its custom authorization functionality.
- NetOne – Consulted on starting up a technology company. Screened resumes and interviewed candidates. Guided leadership to best technologies to use in their implementation.
- Thrive Technologies - Authored a strategic technology roadmap to update their product and processes. Delivered roadmap objectives of (1) implementing Azure DevOps for project boards and work tracking, (2) migrating repositories from Subversion to Git, and (3) migrating product Wiki to Azure DevOps' Wiki.

## Software Engineering Manager – E-commerce Team & Mobile Applications Team

2/2018 – 5/2020

Aaron's, Kennesaw, GA.

Leader of two cross-functional teams: one responsible for [www.aarons.com](http://www.aarons.com)'s software development and the other responsible for Aaron's mobile (Android and iOS) applications. Teams consisted of 8-11 direct-report developers, 4-6 QA's, 2 Tier-3 support, two operations, a UX designer, a product owner, and an architect.

- Worked closely with stakeholders to grow [www.aarons.com](http://www.aarons.com). At the close of 2019, Aarons.com saw quarter over quarter growth of 50% for 8 straight quarters; closing 2019 with over \$150M in revenue.
- Oversaw migration of Aarons.com from ASP.NET StoreFront to the Salesforce Commerce Cloud platform. This effort included vendor management and working with remote and offshore resources and teams.
- Responsible for managing the mobile applications cross-functional team as we built Aaron's first Android and iOS applications, piloted, and launched them.
- Guided both teams to increased efficiencies through leadership, mentorship, process improvements, and personnel management (recruiting, hiring, 1:1's, reviews, compensation, merit increases, etc.).
- Worked with a product owner and architect to prioritize work, refine requirements, write detailed user stories, test plans, and acceptance criteria.
- Fulfilled the Agile Coach (aka Scrummaster) role on the teams. Moved from paper to JIRA agile boards. Made significant JIRA customizations to support the team's workflow. The ecommerce team was Kanban and the mobile apps team was scrum.
- Constant checkout process optimization using A/B testing and statistical analysis
- Ecommerce team was structured in three autonomous squads similar to [Spotify's development team](#).
- Curated a culture based upon these values:

|                              |                                          |
|------------------------------|------------------------------------------|
| Embrace & Drive Change       | Create & Share Fun                       |
| Value Data Over Opinion      | Speak Candidly                           |
| Listen. Challenge. Commit.   | Start Simple. Learn Fast. Iterate Often. |
| Analyze The Wins & Losses    | Default To Go                            |
| Believe Anything Is Possible | Measure Outcomes, Not Output             |
- Implemented a micro-service architecture, Azure DevOps, SOLID principles, and Lean best practices.
- In just 30 days, myself and two other developers utilized Azure Functions, Azure Service Bus (single-pub to multi-sub), and SQL Server to deliver a solution for CCPA (California Consumer Privacy Act) compliance.
- Stayed hand-on in the code working side-by-side with my developers in C#, .NET Core, Azure Functions, MVC5, WebAPI, JavaScript, HTML5, CSS3, SQL Server, React, Jira, BitBucket, TeamCity, Octopus and others.
- Migrated Aarons.com from ASP.NET StoreFront to the Salesforce Commerce Cloud. This involved rewriting many endpoints to micro-service architecture using Azure and multi-targeted (.NET and .NET Core) repos.
- Worked on several third party integrations including BazaarVoice product reviews and talkable referrals.
- Added application insights to all our legacy WebAPI projects to unify our services' monitoring/telemetry.
- Technologies used at Aaron's included C#, .NET, .NET Core (v1-3), Azure, Azure Functions, MVC, WebAPI, Redis, Angular, React, jQuery, JavaScript, HTML5, CSS3, SQL Server, Jira, BitBucket, Octopus and others.

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## Platform and Web Developer

Kahua, Alpharetta, GA.

5/2017 – 2/2018

- Responsible for development on Kahua's C#-based software platform. The work was highly technical and complex; consisting of 46K files and 27M lines of code.
- Upgraded their <https://launch.kahua.com/> web application to new styling and responsive design using C#, MVC5, CSS3, HTML5, jQuery, Bootstrap 3, and Dapper.

## Application Services Team Manager

Institute of Nuclear Power Operations (INPO),  
Atlanta, GA.

1/2005 – 4/2016

- Lead a team of six developers to develop small to medium sized projects and provide application support.
- Did a POC of INPO's first mobile application: INPO2Go using Ionic, AngularJS, WebAPI/OData and others.
- Implemented DevOps CI/CD.
- Lead the application migration project. Was assigned the project three months before it was due in QA and five months before it was due in production. Managed a team of up to a dozen people to migrate intranet applications accessed via VPN to internet applications accessed via SSL/TLS. Migrated 17 web applications, three .NET services, three scheduled jobs and 200+ SSRS reports. Met all project deadlines.
- Project manager, ScrumMaster and lead developer on the INPO Application Security project. Project consolidated two databases into one and provided one common user interface for administering all application security permissions. Delivered as a single-page application (SPA) built using Angular, responsive design (Bootstrap 3), WebAPI RESTful Web Services (C#, MVC, ASP.NET and LINQ to Entities).
- Solution Architect and Lead Developer on the PIC calculations team. At delivery, PIC used SSIS to perform 18 billion calculations every night to deliver 1,200+ performance indicators for the nuclear power industry.
- Project manager, architect, and lead developer on the PIC web application. Website delivered on time, with very few bugs, and was built using C#, ASP.NET, and the AJAX Control Toolkit.
- Project manager, architect, and lead developer on both the CDE (Consolidated Data Entry) 4.0 (MSPI update) and the PIC website projects simultaneously; delivering both on time and on budget.
- Lead developer and project manager in adding MSPI metric to CDE (CDE 3.0).
- Implemented test-driven development (TDD) and automated testing for shared .NET components.
- Screened resumes, performed interviews, made new hires of IT staff, managed contractors and vendors.

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## Professional References

Kevin Leclair

Manager at Aaron's

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☎ 770-331-0831

Christopher Klock

Manager at INPO

✉ [klockcj@gmail.com](mailto:klockcj@gmail.com)

☎ 678-902-1951

Scott Porter

Manager at inLogic

✉ [scott.porter@inlogic.com](mailto:scott.porter@inlogic.com)

☎ 678-793-5139

## Attributes

Creator – A builder/rebuilder/repairer at heart.

Player's coach – Grow talent. Build relationships. Human connection.

DevOps activist – Agile (Scrum and Kanban), deploys/day, CI/CD pipeline, automation, product over project.

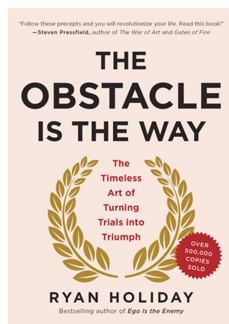
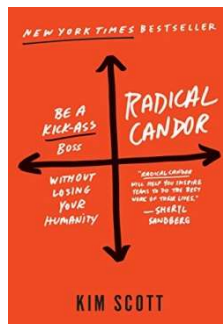
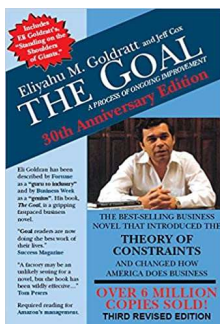
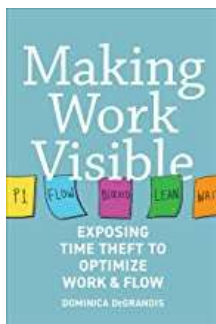
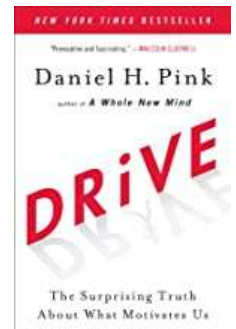
Archenemy of inefficiency – Continuous improvement (CI). Seeks frequent feedback for use in improving.

Change addict – Change is good but hard. Yet it gets easier the more you practice it.

Perpetual Learning – Always learning new things in a wide band of topics.

No habla doublespeak – fluent in plain ol' straight-forward truth.

## Recent Readings



## Technical Publications

Use .NET's BackgroundWorker to Keep ASP.NET Cache in Sync with a Database – 4/2009 – [CodeProject.com](http://CodeProject.com)

Select Distinct Values with XSLT and JavaScript – 11/2001 – [Pinnacle Publishing](http://Pinnacle Publishing) – XML Developer

Implement a Division-of-Labor Approach to Complex XML Manipulation – 6/2001 – [15Seconds.com](http://15Seconds.com)

## Distinctions

**Patriotic Art Award**, First Place at High School, County and State of Georgia levels by the Woman's Auxiliary of the Veterans of Foreign Wars, as a senior in High School

**Eagle Scout Award**, Boy Scouts of America, at the age of 13